

BenQ TK705STi

Best projector for Rs 2.25 lakh if it suits your needs

I live in a typical DDA LIG flat. The living room TV is almost always occupied, mostly playing regional shows, news, or devotional content. If I wanted to watch something else, I had to rely on my laptop. It works, but it never feels as immersive as watching it on a big screen. That got me thinking: what if I could get a bigger screen for my bedroom? A TV was the obvious option, but then another question came up: what if I try a projector instead? There may be many of you in the same or a similar situation, considering or curious about a projector. Well, I spent time researching the category and also spoke with Rajeev Singh, Managing Director at BenQ.

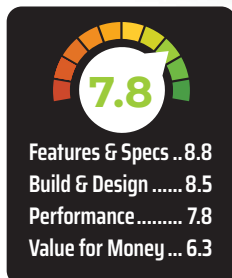
Around the same time, the company sent over the BenQ TK705STi, a premium 4K HDR short-throw projector priced at Rs 2,25,000.

This is not an impulse buy. But it represents what a high-end projector experience looks like today. So even if you are exploring cheaper options, this should give you a benchmark.

DESIGN AND SETUP

The BenQ TK705STi has a compact boxy cube form factor with 229.2 x 168.2 x 249.7 mm dimensions. It is made of a premium polycarbonate shell that looks and feels like metal. Possibly because of the plastic build, the thing weighs only 3.8 kg and can be moved between rooms without much effort. The power adapter is bulky and one more thing to carry along with the main machine.

The projector has built-in stands on top and bottom. On the base, there are



₹2,25,000



three legs which can be rotated to lengthen their height. If you take them out completely, you can use the holes to mount it on a ceiling. You'll have to buy the ceiling mount separately. Neat! Meanwhile, to eject the top stand, you have to hold the projector

upside down and press the oblong button on the back of the projector. At first, I didn't understand that these were cleverly stashed in. I followed BenQ's guides on YouTube to know how they work. Well, you can also refer to the videos on the company's official channel in case you have any doubts.

Prop it opposite a vacant wall or screen, connect it to a power source and use the remote to turn it on and manage the rest of the controls. The light and slim black controller resembles TV remotes. It has the buttons to control the projection's zoom, orientation, volume, and navigation. You also get Google Assistant and hotkeys for streaming platforms like Netflix, YouTube, Prime Video and Live TV.

BenQ also allows remote control via a smartphone app. More on that later.

On the left side of the projector, you get the basic controls to use the projector. On the back side, you will see pores for heat dissipation. This silver colour, metallic finish and pores give it a very Apple Mac Pro-like industrial design. It looks very upstate.

On the back of the device, below the grille, there is a small cavity, where all of its ports are situated. You get the power port, 12V trigger, two HDMI 2.1 ports (one of which supports eARC 7.1 channel for soundbar), a 3.5mm audio output jack, USB-A 2.0 port for media sticks, and a USB-C (DP/PD charging at 30W) port. You can connect a laptop or handheld console like Nintendo Switch through this port for both display and charging purposes.

For wireless connectivity, it has dual-band Wi-Fi 6 (802.11ax) and Bluetooth 5.2. There is also support for Apple AirPlay and Google Cast, if you want to cast something from your phone.

PERFORMANCE

In regular use, I would just plug it in and play some content on YouTube or any of the streaming apps I subscribe to. The projector takes a few seconds to boot and reach the main Google TV homescreen. This is a familiar and simple UI. During the course of my usage, the projector received a 1.13GB system OTA update with some bug fixes and a recent Android security patch.

The UI and navigation felt smooth. I found the MediaTek MT9676 quad-core chipset paired with 2GB of RAM and 16GB of internal storage, fine. On a high-end TV that costs this much, I would expect stronger hardware, but this is the most you get on projectors around the Rs 200,000 price range.

As soon as we start the BenQ projector, the orientation is corrected. You can manually adjust it, but the auto Keystone correction is fine if the machine is set on a flat surface. You can use the stands to better angle the projection.